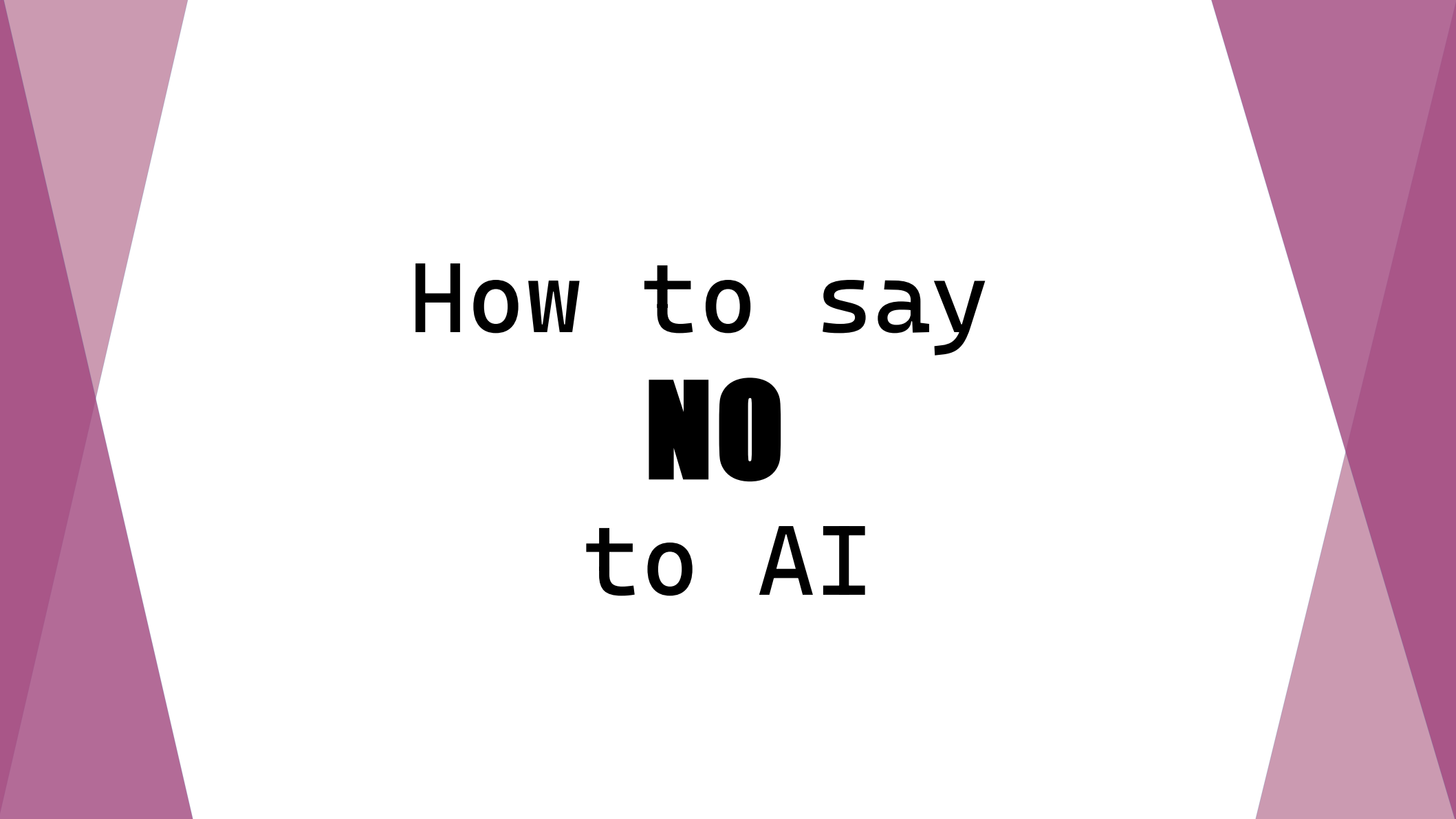




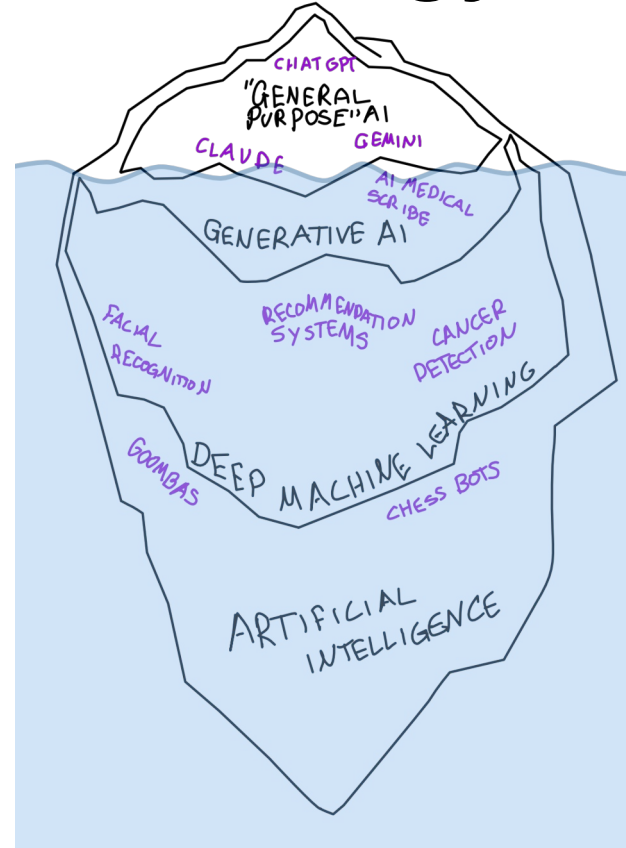
How to say
NO
to AI

Who the hell are you?

- Ayla Taylor
- Data scientist
- Brandeis University Computational Linguistics MS (2022)
- Deeply disillusioned with the industry

A note on terminology:

- “Artificial Intelligence” is a marketing term
- I am primarily talking about “General Purpose” Generative AI
- ALL forms of AI should be examined critically



NEWS

County With 37 AI Art is The
Asks Schools to 'Com
Elect

Microsoft is reportedly planning thousands of layoffs
as it spends on AI

AI sucks.

Exclusive: OpenAI
Kenyan Workers
Than \$2 Per Hour
ChatGPT Less Toxi

Judge Learns
Lawyers on Both
Sides of Case Used AI,
Cancels Trial, Kicks
Everyone Off the Case

Just a few AI harms...

- Mass labor replacement and exploitation
- Concentration and consolidation of wealth
- Systemic bias favoring dominant narratives
- Increasing energy and water use
- Loss of information integrity
- Psychological and emotional distress
- Theft of intellectual property



“It’s here to stay, so
you better get used to it!”

- **Introduction to frameworks of AI resistance**
- How YOU can resist
- Responses to common arguments
- Audience directed activity

"Artificial Intelligence"



FOUR WAYS TO COUNTER NARRATIVES OF AI INEVITABILITY

Resisting AI: Rejecting the ideologies of extraction, datafication and automation

Refusing AI: Targeted Oppositions to AI Applications

Reclaiming AI: Giving communities control of technology design, development and use

Reimagining AI: Collectively reshaping tech narratives through environmental, decolonial lenses



- Introduction to frameworks of AI resistance
- **How YOU can resist**
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Resisting AI in your personal life ...



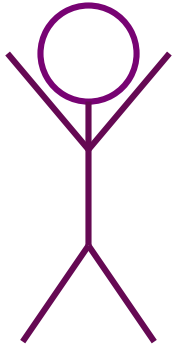
- Learn about the eugenic origins and extractive present of AI and discuss with your friends and family
 - Ghost in the Machine (documentary film)
 - *Empires of AI* by Karen Hao (book)
 - *More Everything Forever* by Adam Becker (book)
 - “The TESCREAL Bundle: Eugenics and the promise of utopia through artificial general intelligence” (article)

Resisting AI in your personal life ...



- Avoid “luxury surveillance” such as smart devices and wearables
 - Surveillance repackaged as convenience and status symbols
- Avoid using AI when you can
 - Stop using Google search (DuckDuckGo allows you to turn off the AI results at least)
 - Fight back against AI usage at work (or at least “say yes, do no”)
 - Follow guides for how to turn off AI features (notoai.org)

Resisting AI in your personal life ...



- Get off Big Tech
 - Chrome → Firefox
 - Gmail → Proton Mail
 - Microsoft Word → LibreOffice
 - Amazon/Audible → Bookshop.org/LibreFM
 - Spotify → Qobuz
 - WhatsApp → Signal
 - GoogleMaps → OpenStreetMaps

Resisting AI in your community ...



- Start conversations about AI harms at work and school
 - Work together with coworkers and classmates (!!!)
 - Focus on what they care most about (labor, creativity, environment, etc)
 - “Do the benefits outweigh the harms?”

Resisting AI in your community ...

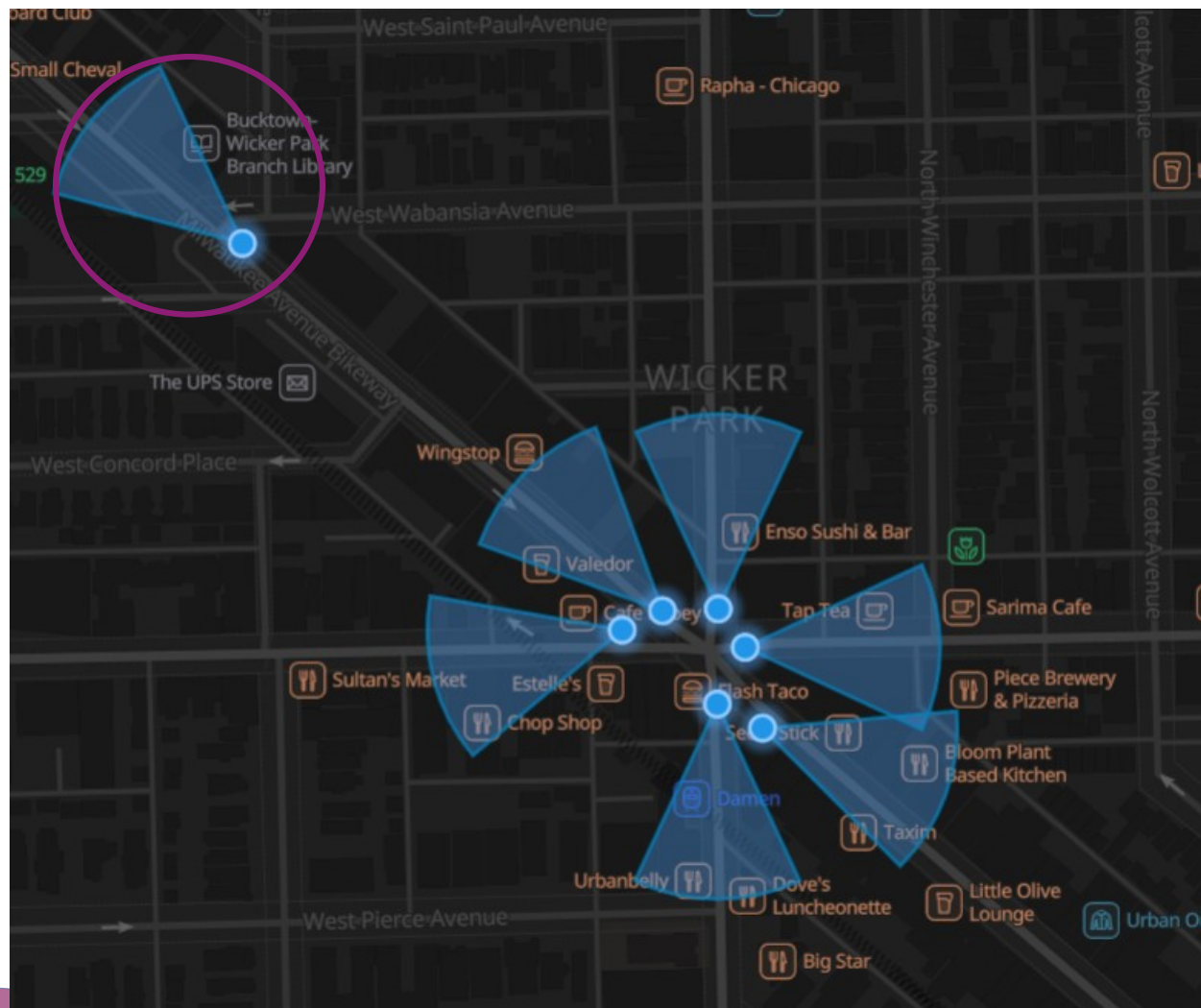


- Call your representatives and tell them to regulate AI and support specific bills
 - The Power Act (HB5513)
 - Protection from Surveillance Pricing Act (HB4248)
 - Several bills about data privacy
 - A bunch about establishing liability for harms

Resisting AI in your community ...



- Research surveillance in your community (Flock, etc)

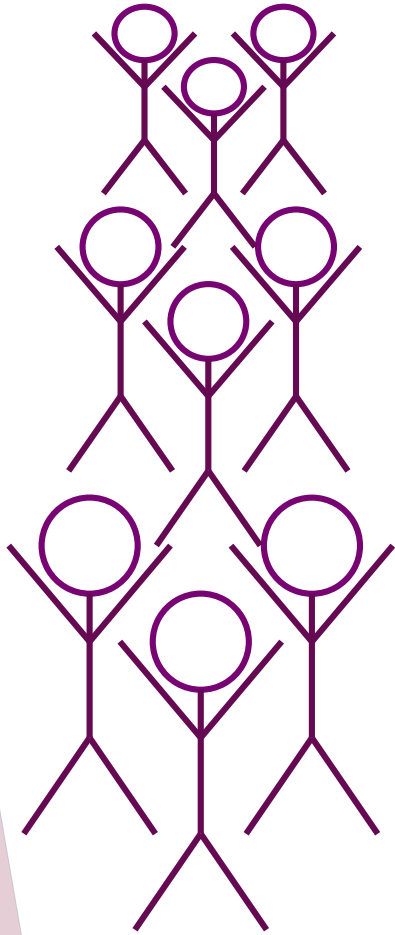


from deflock.org

Resisting AI in your community ...



- Find out about any planned data centers in your area and get involved in resistance
 - Illinois Quantum and Microelectronics Park
 - Several smaller ones on the South Side
 - Joliet Technology Center



Resisting AI around the world ...

- We and AI
- DAIR Institute
- Algorithm Watch
- Data Labelers Association



<https://airesistlist.org/>

- Introduction to frameworks of AI resistance
- How YOU can resist
- **Responses to common arguments**
- Audience directed activity

“There are so many unethical systems, why are you so focused on AI?”

Why should we add another unnecessary, harmful system on top of all the others? Especially one that specifically enables other harms?

“It’s fine, I review everything
I generate with AI.”

Editing is harder than people think! And people are more likely to accept things than change them.

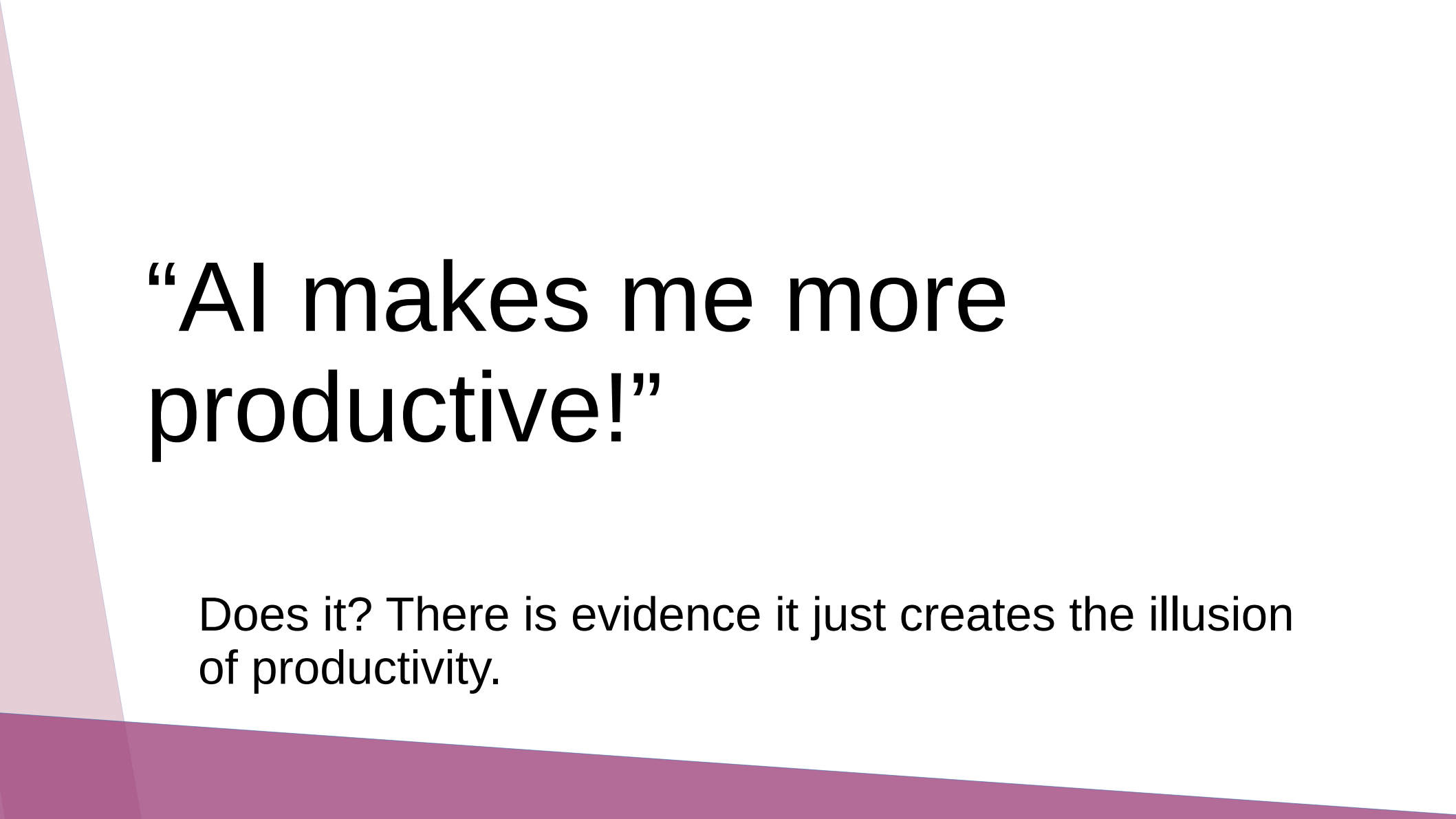


“You can use AI for good things!”

Is that good actually worth the harm? And are you sure it isn't creating hidden harm?

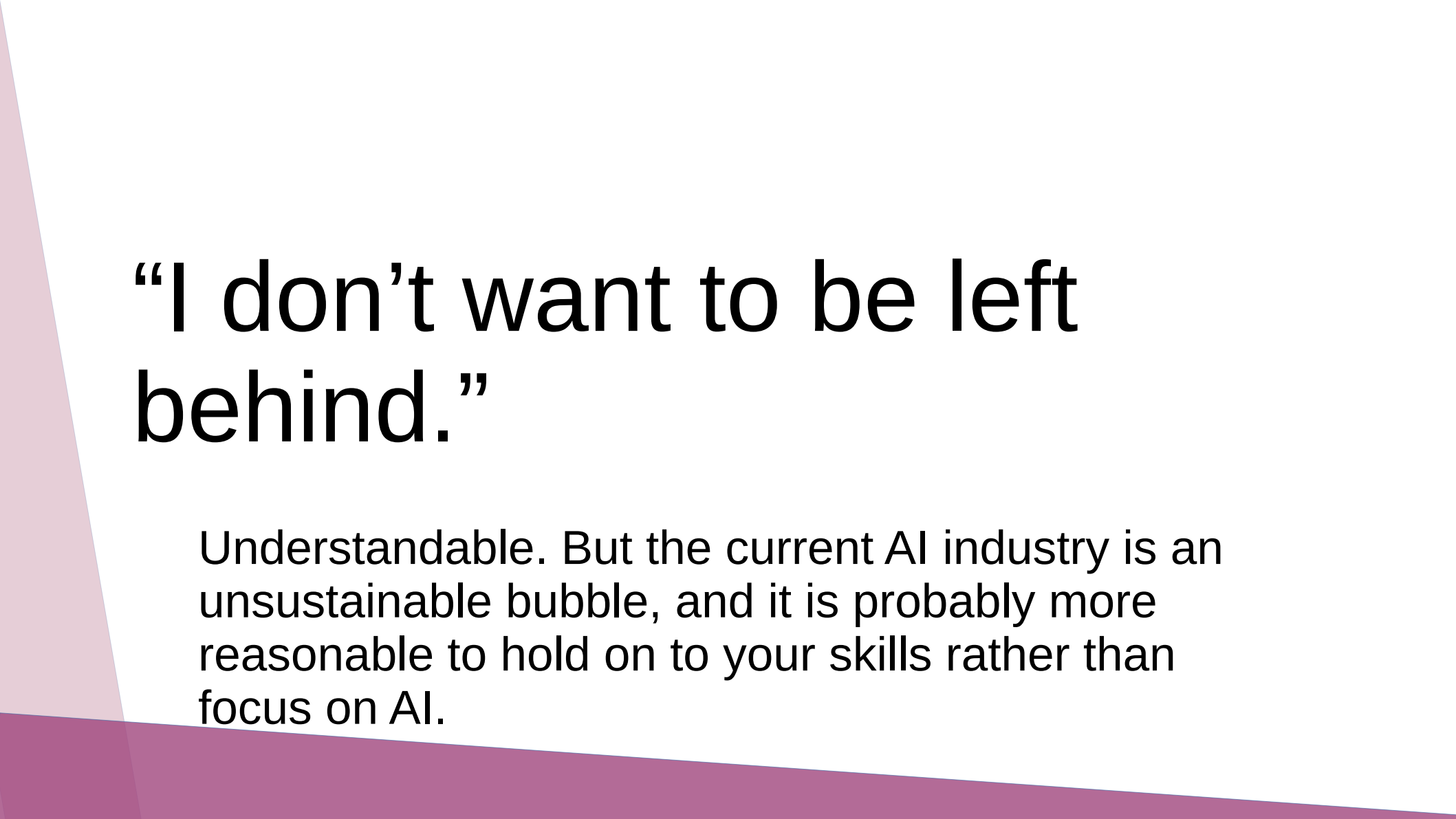
“You are just a Luddite.”

Given that the Luddites actually had very reasonable demands and only turned to machine breaking when all avenues of legal complaint had been eliminated, thank you!



“AI makes me more productive!”

Does it? There is evidence it just creates the illusion of productivity.



“I don’t want to be left behind.”

Understandable. But the current AI industry is an unsustainable bubble, and it is probably more reasonable to hold on to your skills rather than focus on AI.

“I have so much work that I have to use AI to keep up!”

That is a labor issue. You are being given unreasonable amount of work and your employer probably needs to hire more people.

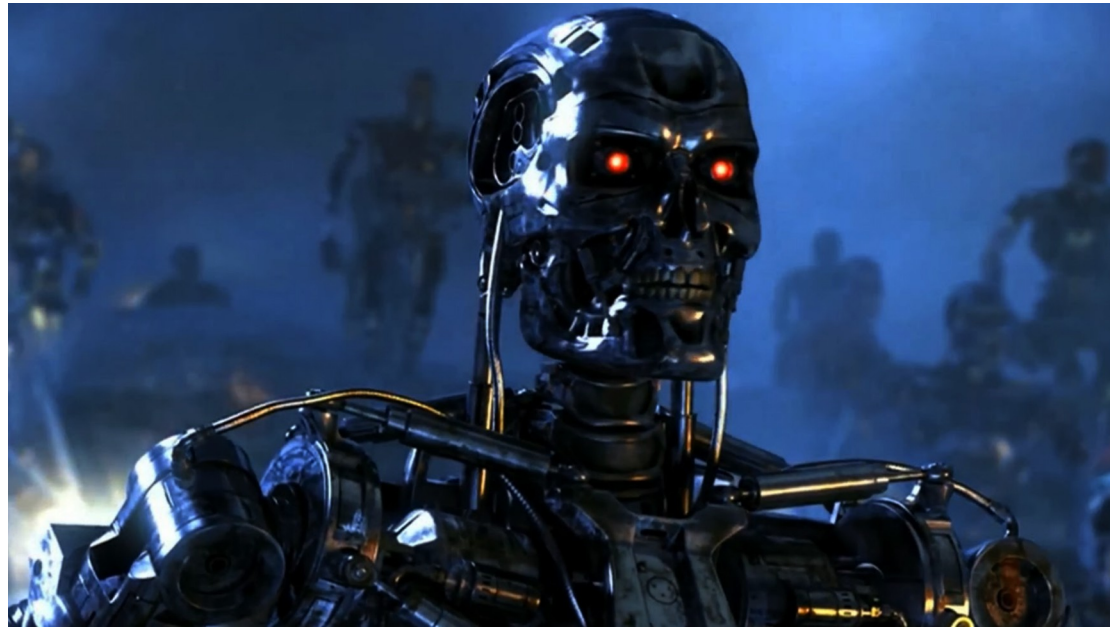
“I need to use AI because I don't know how to write/draw/code/etc.”

Learning is one of the great joys of life and if anyone criticizes you for being a beginner, they are an asshole.

Ask yourself:

- Is my use of AI in accordance with my values?
- Do the benefits outweigh the harms?

A note on “existential risk”



- Introduction to frameworks of AI resistance
- How YOU can resist
- Responses to common arguments
- **Audience directed activity**

Next....

- Make ... anti-AI stickers
- Plan ... specific actions
- Discuss ... what we feel
- Learn ... more background info